

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Shelters saw successes, challenges

Assessing the early months of a merged network that houses migrants, homeless

By Caroline Kubzansky and Nell Salzman
Chicago Tribune

When a converted Kenwood hotel opened its doors to migrants in the summer of 2023, officials who announced the news received vociferous pushback from residents. They had numerous concerns

about the shelter at 4900 S. DuSable Lake Shore Drive: whether migrants would be vaccinated and fingerprinted; how their children would be educated; the food they would eat. And many wanted to know what Chicago was doing for the large and growing homeless population that predated the migrants' arrival. Almost three years later, buses

sent by Texas Gov. Greg Abbott have stopped arriving from the more closely surveilled southern border. The city has closed down most of the facilities it scrambled to stand up to meet waves of asylum-seekers, mostly from Venezuela. Thousands have transitioned to permanent housing. Police stations, once overflowing with newly arrived people, are empty.

What remains is a new, merged shelter network officials have dubbed the One System Initiative, which houses anyone, from

anywhere, who doesn't have a place to go. The city and state were running 28 migrant-exclusive facilities at the peak of arrivals in January of last year, according to city census data. They have collaborated with nonprofits to run 50 total sites across the system, city officials said.

Homeless advocates have long championed the idea of a combined system, saying it would spread out resources to a wider range of people. The first few months under the new system brought changes those advocates

hailed as triumphs, including the opening of a new no-barrier emergency shelter on the Lower West Side that works as a gateway to the social service network for anyone.

Challenges remain. The number of people who need a short-term place to sleep still exceeds the 7,400 beds available in the merged systems. Some facilities are still dealing with bilingual staff shortages. Even if Chicago's emergency shelters were perfectly equipped to meet demand, advocates say

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Retrial for ex-AT&T executive postponed

Allows new US attorney in Chicago to consider next steps in the case

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

A federal judge on Thursday postponed the retrial of ex-AT&T Illinois boss Paul La Schiazza on bribery counts related to former House Speaker Michael Madigan, allowing the new U.S. attorney in Chicago to consider next steps in the case and avoiding the possibility that Madigan would be sentenced in the same courthouse while La Schiazza's jury was deliberating.

The abrupt move came as the parties met for a pretrial conference before U.S. District Judge Robert Gettleman in advance of La Schiazza's retrial, which had been set for June 3.

Instead, Assistant U.S. Attorney Timothy Chapman advised the judge that both sides were in agreement that the trial should be delayed at least until fall, in large part to give prosecutors "more time to consider our position, especially with our new U.S. attorney (Andrew Boutros) coming on board."

"He's basically drinking from a firehose right now in the first few weeks since his arrival," Chapman said.

La Schiazza's attorney said he was in agreement with the delay.

In his first interview with reporters earlier this week, Boutros referenced a series of corruption cases over the past eight months that have ended with the jury deadlocked on some or all counts, most recently last week when a jury failed to reach a verdict on any counts against state Sen. Emil Jones III.

Boutros said his office is looking closely at those cases to see if there are any lessons going forward. He said he suspects some of it "transcends the office and the work that we are doing," and could have more to do with societal or cultural shifts, such as the "CSI" phenom-

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INSIDE

Offense powers Cubs to another series win

Takeaways from series win over the Pirates, including a red-hot Seiya Suzuki leading a power surge. Plus, Paul Sullivan takes stock of the White Sox's Bulls-themed alternate uniforms **Chicago Sports**

Russia, Ukraine launch drone strikes

At least nine were killed hours after Kyiv and Washington signed an agreement granting U.S. access to mineral resources. **Nation & World**



JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Rallies rebuke Trump

Demonstrators head toward Butler Field in Chicago's Grant Park during a May Day march on Thursday. Organized labor and activist groups rallied for protection of immigrants and fair wages as rain sprinkled down, carrying signs that said, "Built by immigrant hands, enjoyed by all," and "Somos el motor de este pais (We are the engine of this country)." Hundreds of thousands turned out for rallies around the world, many uniting against President Donald Trump's agenda. **Chicagoland, Page 3**



Alma Duran greets Flor Dimas, left, at the Parent Mentor Expo on April 25 in Chicago. Duran is a parent mentor who works at Walsh Elementary School. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Immigration policy could leave a lasting impact on students

By Nell Salzman
Chicago Tribune

When President Donald Trump took office and declared Chicago "ground zero" for the largest deportation operation in U.S. history, Alma Duran, 43, said her 10-year-old twins asked why their classes at an elementary school in Pilsen were deserted.

She told them some kids and parents were scared to come in for fear of getting detained and deported, and she explained

the concept of the United States border to her children for the first time — that they were born in Chicago and had documents that some of their classmates might not have.

"And even then, my kids were like, 'How is this possible? How can they be so afraid that they don't even want to come to school? ... Mommy, you always say going to school is good. How is it not good now for some friends?' " Duran remembered them asking her. Trump's hard-line immigra-

tion policy has taken a deep emotional toll on communities with large undocumented populations. And though attendance at Perez has slowly recovered in the months since Trump took office, fear and anxiety linger among parents, teachers and students at some Chicago public schools.

Data obtained by the Tribune through a Freedom of Information Act request shows that attendance rates

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Trump ousts security adviser Waltz

Instead taps him as UN envoy; secretary of state to take on dual role

By Zeke Miller, Aamer Madhani, Seung Min Kim and Farnoush Amiri
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump said Thursday he's nominating his national security adviser Mike Waltz to serve as United Nations ambassador in a major shake-up of his national security team.

The president said Secretary of State Marco Rubio will serve simultaneously as acting national security adviser while maintaining his position at the State Department.

Trump announced the moves shortly after news broke that Waltz was leaving the administration, just weeks after it was revealed that he had added a journalist to a Signal chat being used to discuss military plans.

"I am pleased to announce that I will be nominating Mike Ambassador to the United Nations. From his time in uniform on the battlefield, in Congress and, as my National Security Advisor, Mike Waltz has worked hard to put our Nation's



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